

Peter James Aungle

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EDUCATION

Harvard University Cambridge, MA
PhD, Psychology May 2026
Dissertation: "Embodied models of health: mind-body unity and the psychological determinants of physical health"
Committee: Ellen Langer (primary advisor, committee chair), Leah Somerville, Fiery Cushman

University of California at Berkeley Berkeley, CA
BA, Psychology May 2009

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

oTree Open Source Research Foundation June 2026 – May 2027
Postdoctoral Research Fellow

Harvard University, Department of Psychology June 2026 – May 2027
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Langer Lab

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Research

Health psychology · Mind-body unity · Mindsets, attention, and expectations · Embodied models of health · Belief-based behavioral interventions

Teaching

Social psychology · Health psychology · Research methods · Positive psychology · Mentoring undergraduate researchers

PUBLICATIONS

Aungle, P., & Langer, E. (2023). Physical healing as a function of perceived time. *Scientific Reports*, 13(1), 22432. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-50009-3>

Aungle, P., & Langer, E. (2024). The borderline effect for diabetes: when no difference makes a difference. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 15. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2024.1333248>

Langer, E., & **Aungle, P.** (2024). How much do our thoughts shape our health? *Scientific American*. <https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/how-much-do-our-thoughts-shape-our-health/>

Aungle, P., Holmes, N., & Chen, D. (*Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*). <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/pdf/10.1177/25152459261417257>

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Aungle, P. & Pagnini, F. (*revise and resubmit*). Reconsidering the Exclusion of Langerian Mindfulness: A Commentary on Chems-Maarif et al. (2025). [*Mindfulness*]

- Aungle, P.**, Matta, P.M., Chen, D., & Langer, E. (*under review*). Embodied models of health: A theoretical framework of mind-body unity. <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/ubtxw> v2 [*Perspectives on Psychological Science*]
- Aungle, P.**, Matta, P.M., Loecher, M., Chen, D. (*under review*). A computational framework of mind-body unity: formalizing embodied models of health. <https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/uq934> v1 [*Psychological Review*]
- Aungle, P.**, Bross, J., Nagarathinam, V., Chen, D., & Langer, E. (*under review*). Manipulating temporal expectations to accelerate recovery after cataract surgery: a randomized controlled trial. [*Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*]
- Sapers, N., **Aungle, P.**, Langer, E. (*in prep*). From competencies to enactment: situational construal as a mechanism of transfer in social and emotional learning.
- Aungle, P.**, Zhang, Y., Nagarathinam, V., Paradis, J., Chen, D. (*in prep*). The surprising power of sadness in workplace conflict: when vulnerability outperforms dominance.
- Mehmood, S., Bakhtawar, A., **Aungle, P.**, Brown, H., Reinhart, E., Chen, D. (*in prep*). Trickle-down wellness: the effects of mental health support for teachers on student stress and achievement.
- Mehmood, S., Bakhtawar, A., Brown, H., **Aungle, P.**, Reinhart, E., Chen, D. (*in prep*). Wearing the cure: public signaling in psychiatric care.
- Aydinian, T., Barzilai, D., **Aungle, P.**, Langer, E. (*in prep*). Mindfulness, mind-body unity, and longevity.

PRESENTATIONS

- Aungle, P.**, Bross, J., Nagarathinam, V., Chen, D., & Langer, E. (scheduled 2026, September). Manipulating temporal expectations to accelerate healing after cataract surgery: A randomized controlled trial. Paper presented at the Advances with Field Experiments Conference, Chicago, IL.
- Aungle, P.**, Zhang, Y., Nagarathinam, V., Paradis, J., & Chen, D. (2026, August). The surprising power of sadness in workplace conflict: When vulnerability outperforms dominance. Paper presented at the Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.
- Aungle, P.** (2026, April). Embodied models of health: Mind-body unity and the psychological determinants of physical health. Invited talk, Stanford Mind & Body Lab (Alia Crum), Stanford University, Stanford, CA.
- Aungle, P.** (2023, April). Expectations & health: Thinking in terms of mind-body unity. Invited talk, Social Psychology Research Seminar, Department of Psychology, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA.
- Aungle, P.** (2022, September). Perceived time and wound healing. Second-year project talk presented to the Department of Psychology, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA.

HONORS, AWARDS, AND GRANTS

2026 – 2027	Postdoctoral Research Fellowship, oTree Open Source Research Foundation (\$70,000)
2023 – 2024	Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Harvard University (Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2024)
2024 – 2025	Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard Griffin Graduate School of Arts and Sciences
2023 – 2024	Departmental Pedagogy Fellow, Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning, Harvard University
2024	Graduate Research Grant, Restricted Funds Committee, Harvard Department of Psychology (\$7,500, maximum award)
2022	Graduate Research Grant, Restricted Funds Committee, Harvard Department of Psychology (\$5,000)
2019	Stimson Fund Research Award, Harvard Department of Psychology (\$1,000)
2019 – 2021	Harvard Griffin GSAS Graduate Fellowship (full stipend and tuition)

Grant Applications Under Review

2026	John Templeton Foundation, “Mind Body Economics” (with Daniel L. Chen), \$738,428, submitted July 2026
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Ten semesters of teaching experience with an average rating of 4.6/5.0

Harvard University, Psychology Department

Sole Instructor

“Instructional Styles in Psychology” Fall 2023, Spring 2024 — designed and taught the required pedagogy course for incoming psychology teaching fellows. Average rating 4.5/5.0.

Head Teaching Fellow

“Health: A Positive Psychology Perspective” (Ellen Langer). Fall 2023, 2025, 2026 (scheduled) — co-designed the syllabus and section materials; in 2025, taught all five sections (80 students). Average rating 4.88/5.0.

Teaching Fellow

“Introduction to Social Psychology” (Fiery Cushman; Ashwini Ashokkumar) — Spring 2023, 2026. Average rating 4.67/5.0.

“The Emotional Mind” (Leah Somerville) — Spring 2024. Average rating 4.5/5.0.

“Health: A Positive Psychology Perspective” (Ellen Langer) — Fall 2021, 2022. Average rating 4.32/5.0.

“Introduction to Psychological Science” (Jason Mitchell) — Spring 2022. Average rating 4.38/5.0.

Pedagogy Fellow (2023–24)

Advised teaching fellows, attended weekly Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning workshops, and completed a capstone supporting future psychology pedagogy fellows.

Thesis Advising

Hudson Brown, Harvard College senior thesis (in progress, 2026–2028) — “Can People Be Taught to Smell Disease?”

Nicole Modina, Harvard Extension School ALM thesis (2026) — “The Set of the Mind Matters: Perceived Energy, Focus, and the Placebo Effect”

Henry Tager, Harvard Extension School ALM thesis (2024) — “Is Coastal Living Positively Associated with Increased Trait Mindfulness?”

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Columbia University

Research Assistant

New York, NY

2018 – 2019

Advisor: Janet Metcalfe

Project: Learning from errors

- Created problem sets for study participants designed to maximize what students learn from errors while preparing for the New York State Math Regents exam
- Consulted on the experimental design, particularly in terms of how to explain common errors and relate to the correct problem-solving process

University of California at Berkeley

Research Assistant

Berkeley, CA

2006 – 2009

Advisor: Darlene Francis

Projects: The development of risk preferences in rat pups; the effects of rank in social hierarchies on behavior in a competitive task

- Ran a study testing whether prenatal stress affects risk-taking in rat pups; prenatally stressed pups took significantly more physically threatening risks than controls.
- Designed and ran a study testing whether within-group social rank predicts competitive performance, pairing unfamiliar rats matched on physical dominance cues but differing in rank; higher-ranked rats outperformed comparable peers, though not significantly.

University of California at Berkeley

Research Assistant

Berkeley, CA

2007 – 2008

Advisor: Jack Glaser

Project: Implicit motivation to control prejudice

- Ran participants for an experimental study examining the implicit motivation to control prejudice in a “Shooter Task”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Private Tutor, Smarter Test Prep, 2011 – 2021

Independent Options Trader & Investment Analyst, 2014 – 2016

Sales Analyst, Aflac Insurance Company, 2010 – 2011

Business Development Services Analyst, Goldman Sachs Asset Management, 2009 – 2010

Communications Analyst, Hattaway Communications, 2008 – 2009

Press Advance Lead, National Advance Team, Hillary Clinton for President, 2007 – 2008

REFERENCES

Ellen J. Langer, Ph.D.

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Leah H. Somerville, Ph.D.

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Daniel L. Chen, J.D., Ph.D.

Professor of Economics
School of Economics
Toulouse University
Toulouse, France
CASBS Fellow, Stanford
University, 2026–2027
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